

Partnership Strategy Playbook.

Align Phase.

Prepared by **HockeyStick Advisory** for **SafetyCulture**. The culmination of the Align Phase workshop, the opportunity mapping pass, and the business alignment build — ready for executive sign-off and the board.

Agenda.

From the partnership vision and commercial impact analysis through the How-to-Win playbook to the Crawl-Walk-Run workstreams and the key areas of focus.

01

Vision

Partnership vision · What's possible through partnerships

02

The Role of Partnerships

Ecosystem map · Maturity · Readiness · Strategy · Customer journey

03

The Commercial Impact of Partnerships

Competitor analysis · GTM channels · Bottom-up model · Reconciliation

04

How to Win

What we want from partners · What we offer · Inputs + outputs

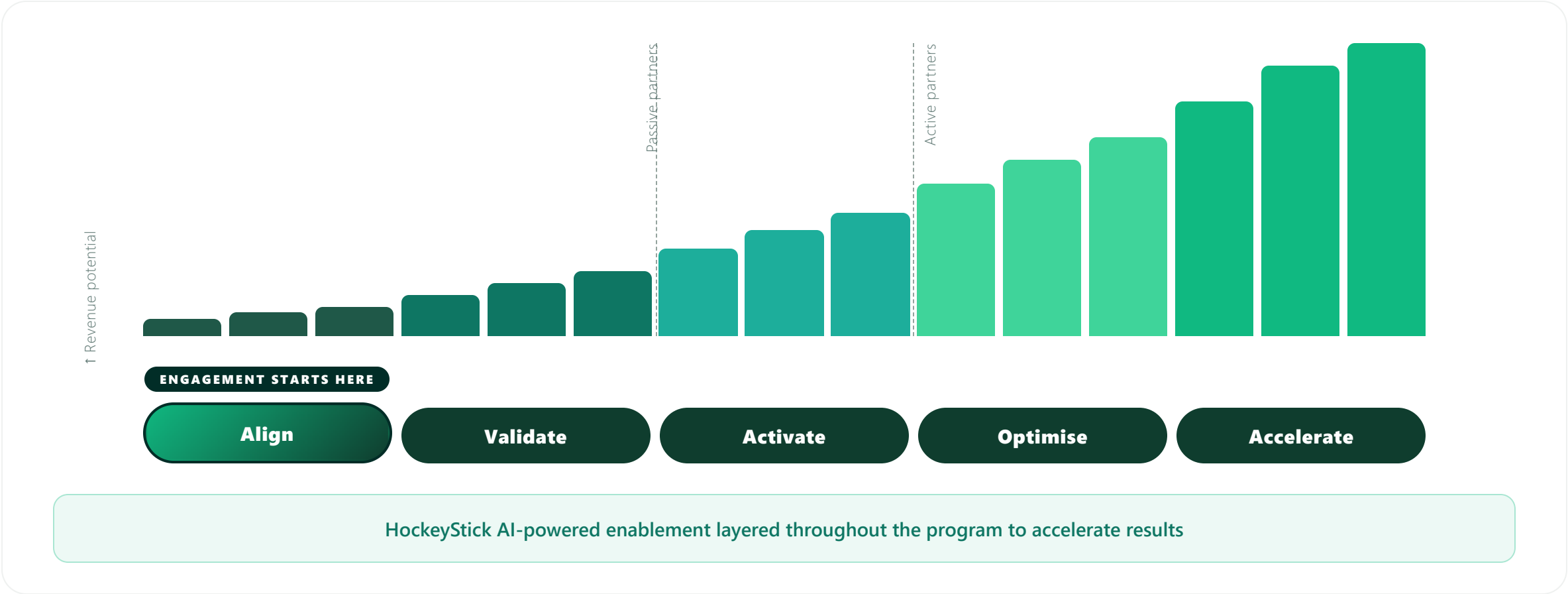
05

Crawl, Walk, Run

Four starred workstreams · Crawl-Walk-Run cadence · Key areas of focus · 24-month timeline

The HockeyStick Partnerships Framework · five pillars to compounding partner revenue.

Align · Validate · Activate · Optimise · Accelerate. Every engagement begins at Align. HockeyStick walks SafetyCulture through all five pillars. Revenue grows exponentially as partners move from passive to active.



HOCKEYSTICK · OUR VISION

Vision: To enable partnerships as the primary growth driver *for ambitious companies*, driving exponential outcomes for customers and partners.

Clients include many leading tech companies

Tech Council of Australia	Australia Post	ELMO	Firmable	Tractor Ventures	Innovation Bay	Stripe
Lawpath	Uber	SafetyCulture	Amaka	NZ Trade & Enterprise	Qsic	Tapestry
WorkflowMax	Easy Agile	CareTeq	ClearCalcs	Affix	Marsello	April
Empiraa	Pencil	Coachbar	Qbox	MyHub	Mentorloop	AlphaSights
Kloud Connect	Yttrium	ApprovalMax	XBert	Little Phil	Submarine	Incloud

SAFETYCULTURE PARTNERSHIP VISION

Admired by our customers and partners for the value we create together, and the way in which we engage with them.

SafetyCulture is the partner of choice. Partners prioritise their resources, time and operating model toward creating win-wins that achieve business outcomes and drive growth.

What's possible through partnerships?

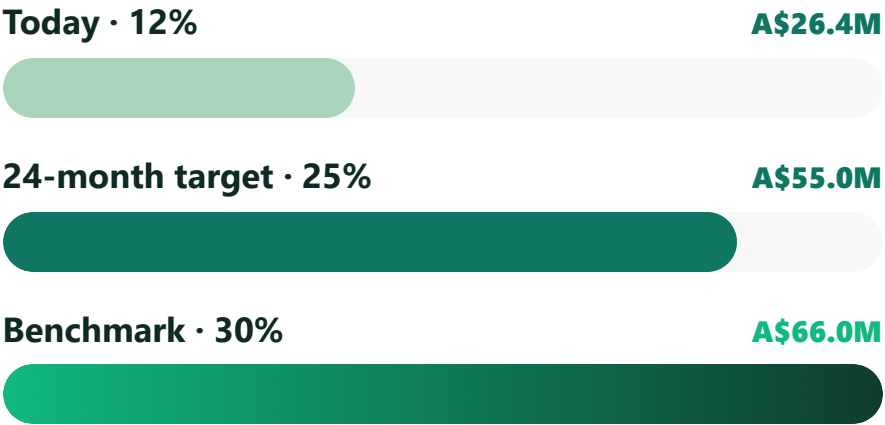
Today partners source 12% of SafetyCulture's A\$220M revenue. Moving to the 25% 24-month target and on toward the 30% top-quartile benchmark sizes the partner-attributable revenue on the table.

CLOSEABLE PARTNER-REVENUE GAP · 24 MONTHS

A\$28.6M

Closing the gap from today's 12% to the 25% 24-month target unlocks A\$28.6M of partner-sourced revenue not in the plan today.

PARTNER-SOURCED REVENUE · A\$M

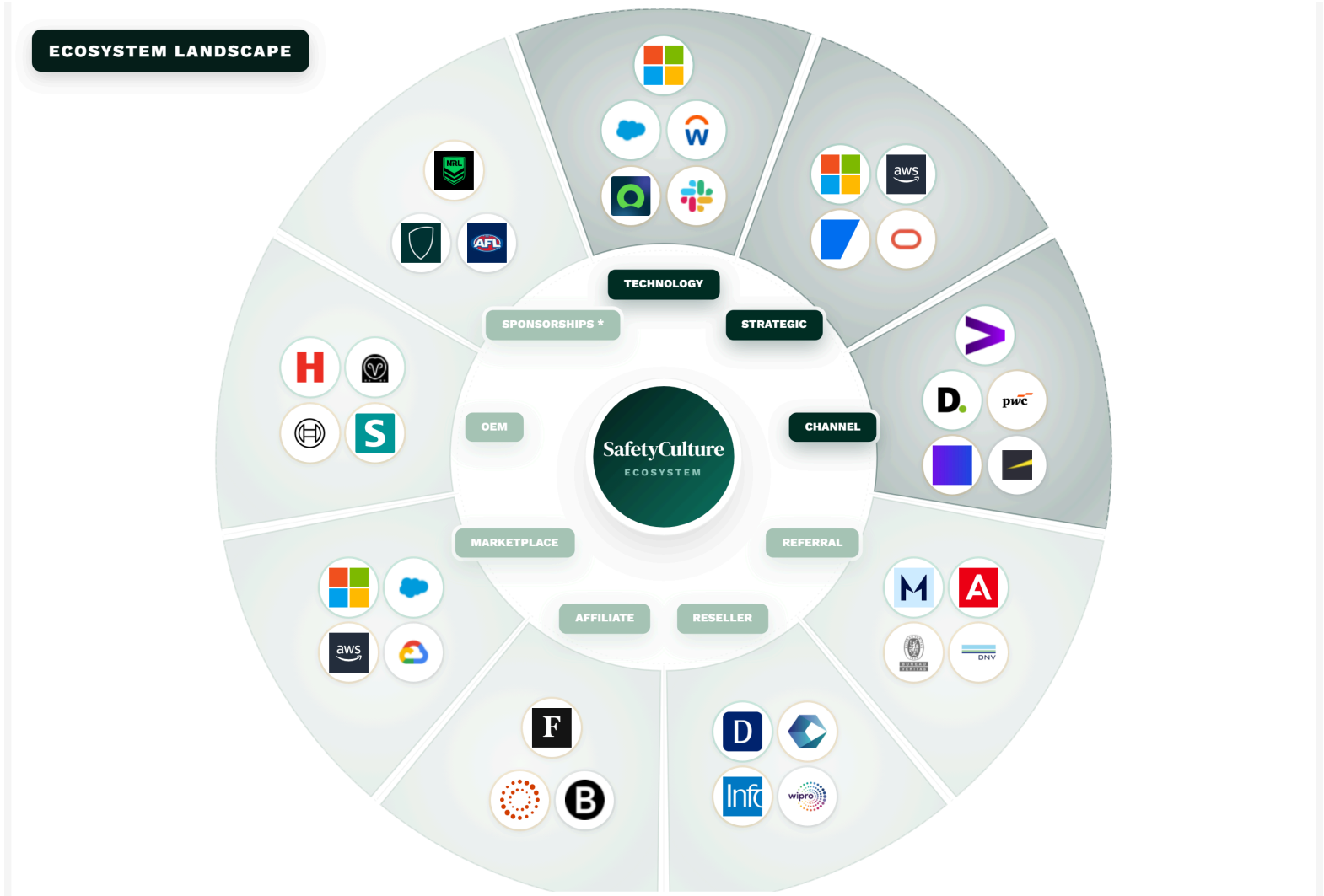


Based on A\$220M company revenue · Crossbeam top-quartile benchmark

SECTION 03

The Role of Partnerships.

Ecosystem prioritisation · map.



Partner Categories · Definition, Value Add and Company Outcomes.

The eight canonical partner categories — their definitions, the value each adds, and the company outcomes they drive.

	Technology / ISVs	Reseller	Channel / Solution Partners	Marketplaces	Referral Partners	Affiliate Partners	Strategic Alliances	OEM / Embedded
Definition	A third-party company that integrates its platform with yours to unlock new workflows.	A company that resells to customers and makes money on the margin from resale.	A company that provides professional services through sales and delivery motions.	A third-party online marketplace such as AWS, Google or Microsoft.	A third party that refers potential customers in exchange for mutual benefits or incentives.	An individual or media partner that earns commission for driving traffic, sign-ups or sales.	A peer-level company alliance that delivers joint GTM and joint product motion.	A third party that embeds your capability inside its product and ships it to customers.
Value Add	1. Unlock capabilities 2. Brand awareness 3. Adoption 4. Customer reach and access	1. Contractual leverage 2. Financial incentives 3. Ease of procurement 4. Customer reach	1. Capability 2. Capacity 3. Customer reach + access 4. Tailored solutions 5. Adoption	1. Financial incentives 2. Ease of procurement 3. Brand awareness 4. Champions with access to buyers	1. Influence with buyers 2. Lead qualification 3. Sales capacity 4. Customer acquisition	1. Top-of-funnel reach 2. Always-on content 3. Brand authority 4. Low-touch acquisition	1. Enterprise procurement access 2. Co-sell motion 3. Reference architectures 4. Brand halo	1. Embedded distribution 2. Always-on consumption 3. Compounding without sales load 4. Vertical penetration
Company Outcomes	1. Influenced ARR 2. Increase ACV 3. Increase win rates 4. Increase product usage	1. New logo acquisition 2. Market expansion 3. Faster GTM 4. Local compliance + support	1. Lower services delivery cost 2. Increase win rates 3. Increase ACV 4. Increase NRR / GRR 5. Logo acquisition	1. Increased visibility 2. Higher conversion win rates 3. Larger ACV 4. Streamlined procurement 5. Faster time to value	1. Cost-effective customer acquisition 2. Accelerate GTM 3. New logos 4. ARR growth 5. Geographic expansion	1. Cheaper top-of-funnel 2. Volume sign-ups 3. Brand awareness 4. SEO and domain authority	1. Enterprise pipeline 2. Multi-year contracts 3. Joint roadmap 4. Defensible moat	1. Volume consumption ARR 2. Lower CAC 3. Vertical depth 4. Defensible footprint

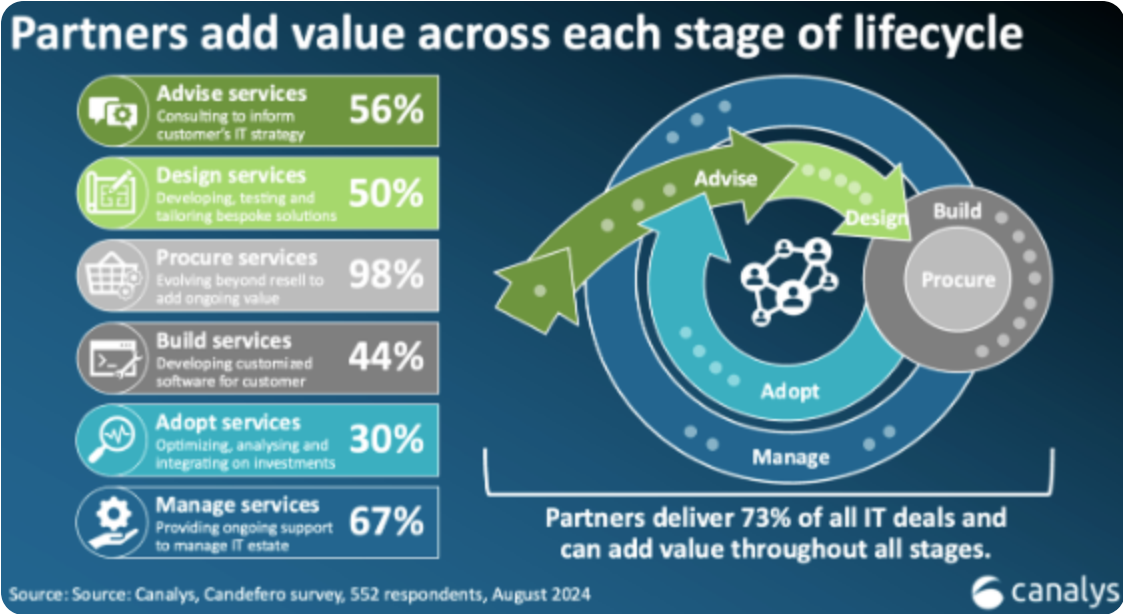
GTM MODELS ARE SHIFTING

Partners are expanding their services *before, during and after* the transaction.

A partner ecosystem model (including the people, processes, program & underlying technology) has moved from *a nice-to-have* to *a need-to-have*.



Jay McBain
Chief Analyst, Canalys



ECOSYSTEM MATURITY · DIAGNOSTIC FINDINGS

SafetyCulture is **Developing** on the partnership ecosystem maturity scale.

Composite 2.1 / 5.0 · benchmark 4.0 for Late-Stage / Pre-IPO programmes (–1.9). Align-phase work will compound.

COMPOSITE

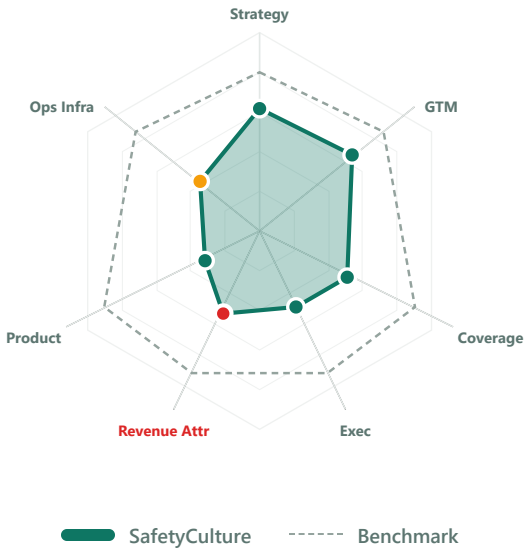
2.1 / 5.0

CLASSIFICATION

Developing

1.5 – 2.5 band

RADAR · 7 DIMENSIONS × BENCHMARK



SCORE BY DIMENSION · SORTED WORST-FIRST

DIMENSION	SCORE	BENCHMARK	DELTA
Revenue Attribution Sourced + influenced tracking	1.4	4.0	-2.6
Operational Infrastructure PRM · CRM · RevOps · enablement	1.8	4.3	-2.5
Ecosystem Coverage Partner base breadth + activation	2.2	4.4	-2.2
GTM Integration Partners in the sales motion	2.4	4.0	-1.6
Executive Commitment Sponsor · reporting line · budget	2.6	4.2	-1.6
Product & Integration API · integrations · marketplace	2.7	4.3	-1.6
Partnership Strategy Maturity Documented strategy + motion	3.1	4.3	-1.2

PARTNERSHIP READINESS · DIAGNOSTIC



SafetyCulture is **Amber** across 3 of 7 readiness categories.



People 2.5/5 Right team, structure and seniority. Partner team headcount, RevOps support and exec sponsor seniority. Weak score means activation outpaces delivery. AMBER 2 blockers	Process 4.1/5 Repeatable mechanics across the engagement. Playbooks, deal-reg flows, attribution rules and joint-motion templates. Strong score means partner work is operational, not artisanal. GREEN 0 blockers	Programs 3.8/5 Formal partner-program structure. Tiering, certifications, MDF and commercials per category. Strong score means each category has a defined incentive shape. GREEN 1 blocker	Technology 1.6/5 Systems and accessibility for partners. PRM, CRM partner-attribution fields and integration plumbing. Weak score blocks every other pillar — partners cannot transact at scale. RED 3 blockers	Data 2.8/5 Partner activity tracking + attribution. Sourced + influenced revenue, partner scorecards, dashboards. Weak score means partners cannot be measured or rewarded. AMBER 2 blockers	Budget 2.4/5 Funding protocol + MDF envelope. Joint marketing dollars, co-sell incentives, partner-manager headcount. Strong score frees the team to invest into activation. AMBER 1 blocker	Exec buy-in 4.5/5 Senior leadership ownership across the C-suite. Exec sponsor cadence, partnership at QBRs, board-level visibility. Strong makes partnerships an embedded priority. GREEN 0 blockers
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Win rate against benchmark and deal size.

ANNUAL MISSED REVENUE · THE COMMERCIAL HOOK

\$1.70M left on the table

Closing the gap from a **22% direct win rate** to the **41% partner benchmark**, applied to SafetyCulture’s annual qualified opportunity volume and annual contract value.

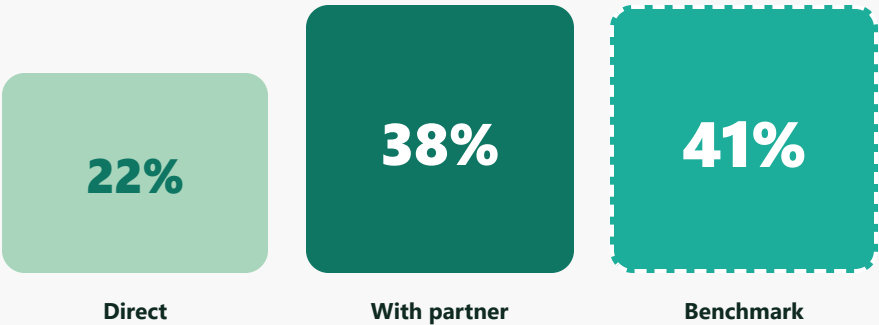
INPUTS

Gap to benchmark	19pp
Annual contract value	\$ 28,000
Annual opportunities	320

Formula: (benchmark – direct) × annual contract value × annual opportunities.

WIN RATE

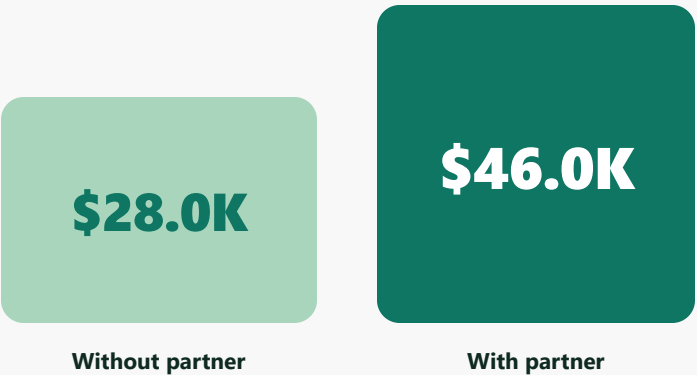
Share of qualified opportunities that close.



Gap to benchmark: +19pp

AVERAGE DEAL SIZE

Average annual contract value per closed deal.



Lift: +64%

Where to play, how to win.

SafetyCulture's partnership strategy on one page. Five strategy questions that frame the partnership programme.

01 · VISION

What is our winning aspiration?

Become the global standard frontline-operations platform for safety-critical industries, building a category-defining partner ecosystem that delivers 22% of new ARR by T+180 and 34% by Year 2, anchored on hyperscaler co-sell, Tier-1 GSI delivery, and an embedded ISV programme.

02 · PLAY

Where will we play?

Primary: ANZ + NAM enterprise frontline operations, scaled through Hyperscaler co-sell (Microsoft / AWS) and Tier-1 GSI delivery (Accenture / Deloitte / PwC).
Secondary: embedded ISV motion across industrial IoT + EHS-adjacent platforms. Verticals: manufacturing, mining, construction, healthcare.

03 · WIN

How will we win in chosen markets?

Integrator-first GTM with named partner managers reporting into Revenue. Software-led differentiation through native integrations and a procurement-ready pricing track. Fast POCs anchored on Activation. Outcome bias: partner-influenced ARR plus joint reference logos every quarter.

04 · CAPABILITIES

What capabilities must we have?

Named Head of Partnerships reporting into the CRO. Dedicated RevOps embed for partner attribution and scorecard cadence. Certification programme for Sales + Partner Managers. C-Suite or President-level executive sponsor on the fortnightly partnership review.

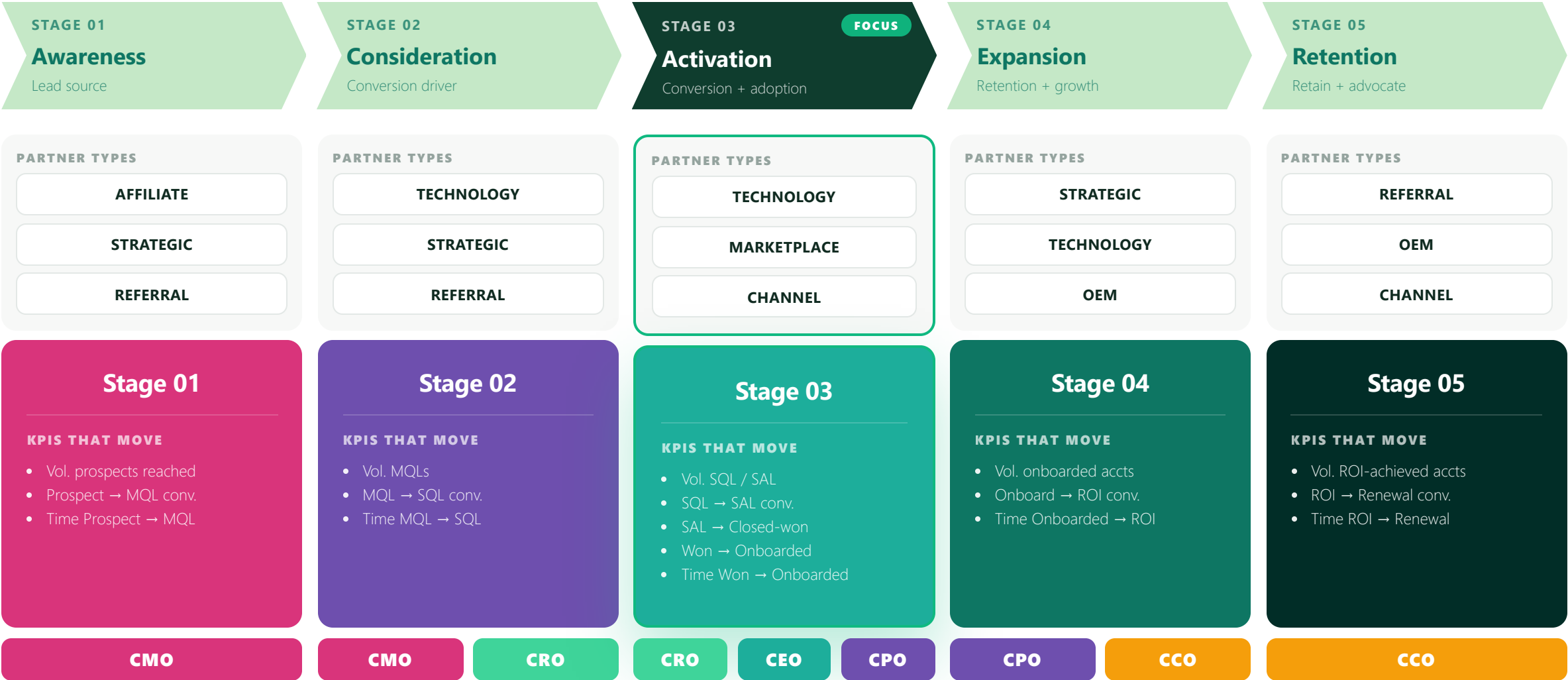
05 · SYSTEMS

What management systems do we need?

CRM partner-attribution fields and workflows. PRM (Crossbeam / PartnerStack) for deal registration and pipeline visibility. Centralised collateral hub for sales, technical, and marketing materials. Quarterly MDF envelope sized to the top 3 categories.

Partners across the customer journey.

5-stage buyer journey · partner types · KPIs that move · executive owners. Activation is the focus stage for FY26.



MAPPING PARTNERS TO THE CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Technology · ISVs.

Category:
Technology · ISVs

| What this category brings to SafetyCulture: native software integrations that deepen the SafetyCulture stack into customers' enterprise systems — Microsoft, Salesforce, Workday, ServiceNow, Slack.

CUSTOMER NEED #1 ☆

Workflow consolidation

Reduce app sprawl by surfacing inspection data inside Teams, Slack, Salesforce and ServiceNow.

CUSTOMER NEED #2 ☆

Data flow + reporting

Push inspection + incident records into the enterprise data warehouse and BI tooling (Power BI, Tableau).

CUSTOMER NEED #3 ☆

Identity + access control

Enterprise SSO, SCIM provisioning, conditional access via the same identity provider.

CUSTOMER NEED #4 ☆

Compliance automation

Auto-route findings to GRC + ITSM platforms; align audit evidence with existing controls.

Customer need #5 ★

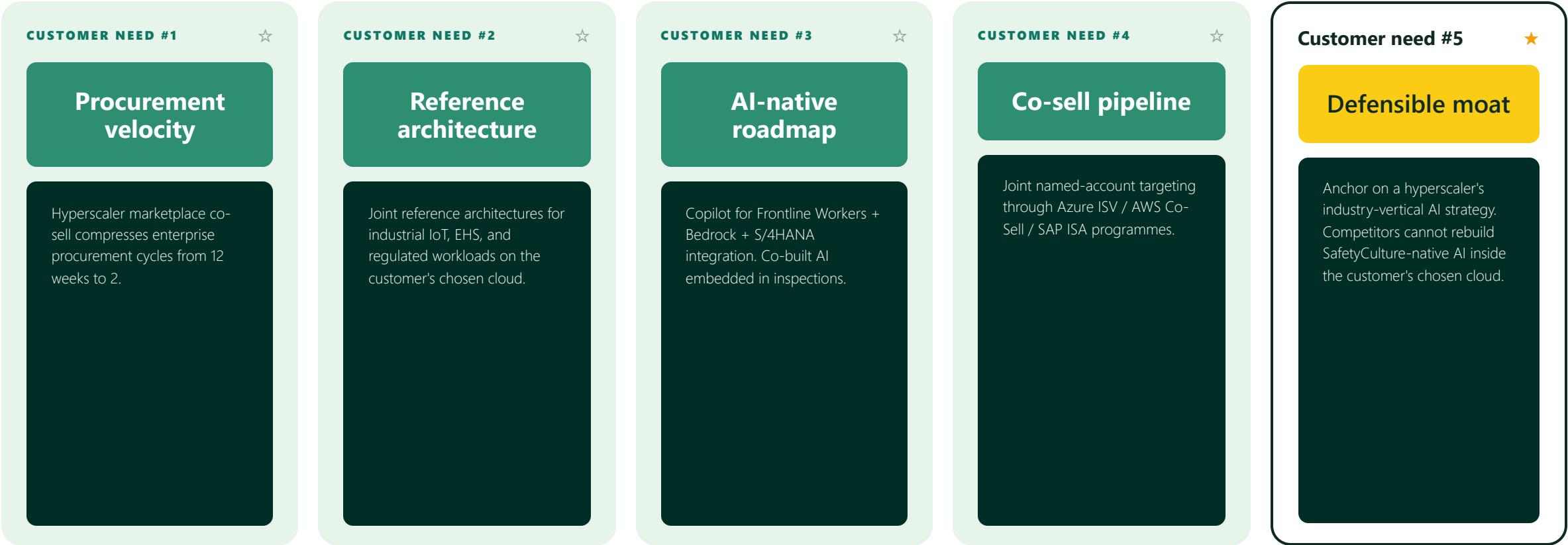
AI + analytics depth

Apply enterprise AI (Copilot, Einstein, Now Assist) directly to SafetyCulture data, without an extra integration team.

MAPPING PARTNERS TO THE CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Strategic · Hyperscalers.

Category: Strategic · Hyperscalers | *What this category brings to SafetyCulture: industrial-IoT-grade cloud + AI platform with marketplace co-sell and procurement velocity for enterprise — AWS, Microsoft Azure, SAP, Oracle.*

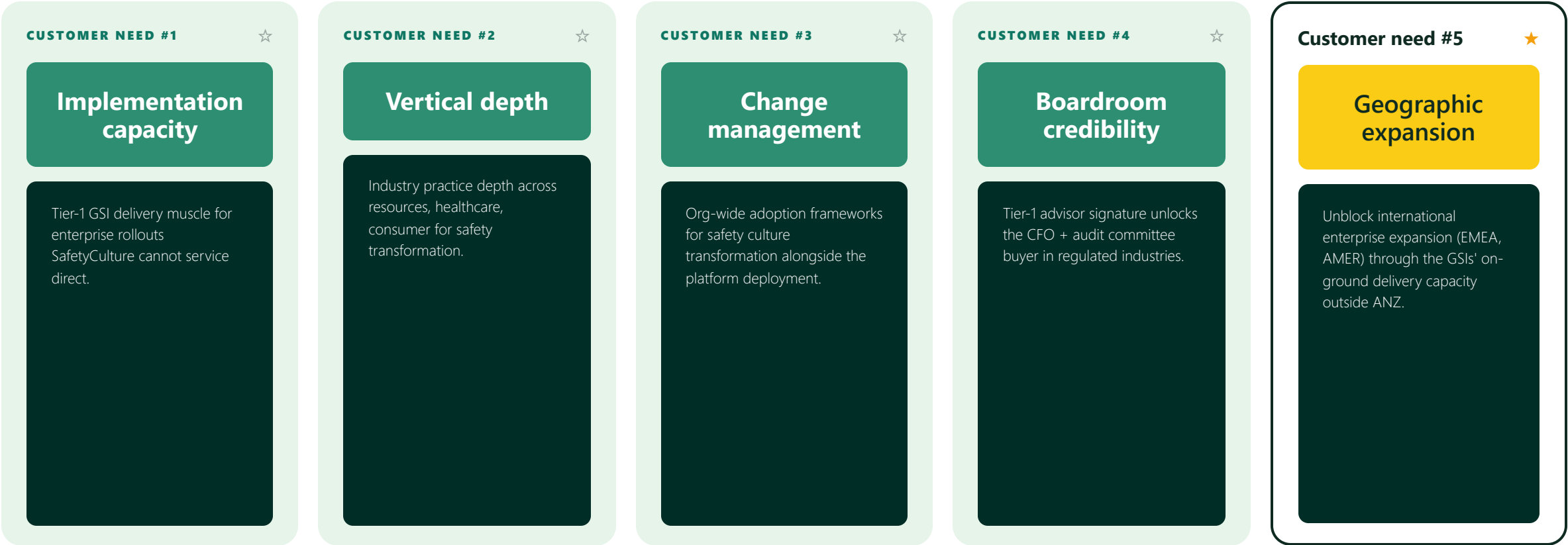


MAPPING PARTNERS TO THE CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Channel · GSIs.

Category:
Channel · GSIs

| What this category brings to SafetyCulture: Tier-1 implementation muscle, vertical-industry depth, and boardroom credibility for enterprise rollouts — Accenture, Deloitte, PwC, KPMG, EY.



SECTION 04

The Commercial Impact of Partnerships.

Partnership Growth Model · Year 1.

The top-down projected contribution of Product, Marketing, Sales and Partnerships to future revenue growth.

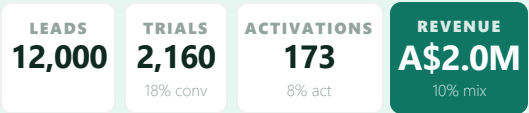
EXPECTED PARTNERSHIP REVENUE · YEAR 1

Top-down annual revenue target for the partnership programme

A\$20.0M

PRODUCT-LED GROWTH

Self-serve trials convert to small-team purchases.



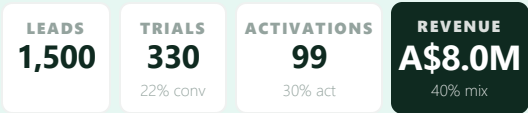
MARKETING LED

Content, paid, and events fill the pipeline.



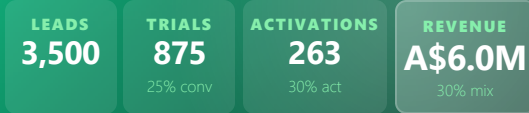
SALES LED · OUTBOUND

Direct outbound into named enterprise accounts.



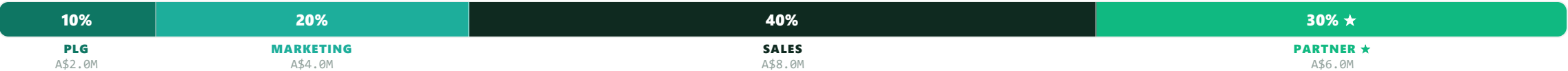
PARTNER LED ★

Partners source and deliver. The compounding lever.



REVENUE MIX · YEAR 1 · A\$20.0M

Σ 100%



PARTNER-LED MIX · CATEGORY VIEW · YEAR 1



Partnership Growth Model · Year 2.

The top-down projected contribution of Product, Marketing, Sales and Partnerships to future revenue growth.

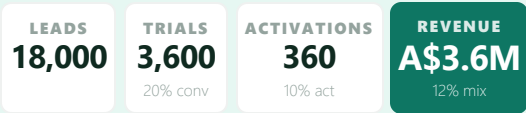
EXPECTED PARTNERSHIP REVENUE · YEAR 2

Top-down annual revenue target for the partnership programme

A\$30.0M

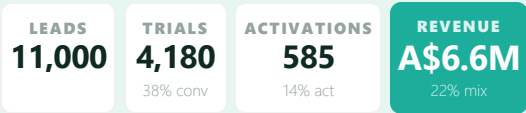
PRODUCT-LED GROWTH

Self-serve trials convert to small-team purchases.



MARKETING LED

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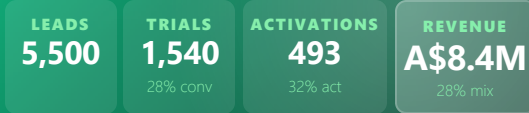
SALES LED · OUTBOUND

Direct outbound into named enterprise accounts.



PARTNER LED ★

Partners source and deliver. The compounding lever.



REVENUE MIX · YEAR 2 · A\$30.0M

Σ 100%

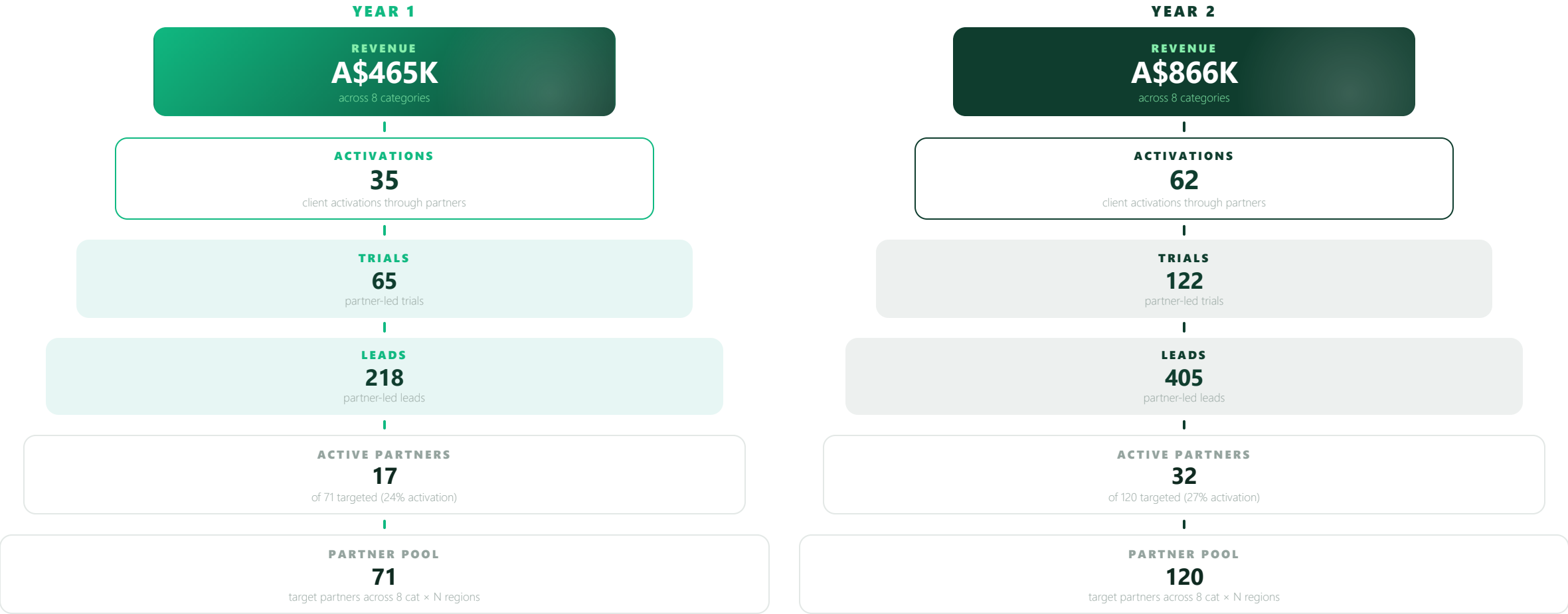


PARTNER-LED MIX · CATEGORY VIEW · YEAR 2



Bottom-Up Partnership Model · Yr 1 + Yr 2 funnel build-up.

Built from the partner pool up to the partner-led revenue total — one funnel per year.



Category view + reconciliation · Yr 1 vs Yr 2.

Bottom-Up category contribution per year (top), and the reconciliation against the R2 Partner-Led top-down slice per year (bottom).

YEAR 1 · CATEGORY VIEW

AFFILIATE A\$200K 9 active	RESELLER A\$65K 7 active
STRATEGIC A\$60K 3 active	REFERRAL A\$80K 9 active
INTEGRATION A\$20K 3 active	MARKETPLACE A\$22K 2 active
CHANNEL A\$10K 1 active	OEM A\$8K 1 active

YEAR 2 · CATEGORY VIEW

AFFILIATE A\$370K 14 active	RESELLER A\$120K 11 active
STRATEGIC A\$110K 5 active	REFERRAL A\$150K 11 active
INTEGRATION A\$40K 3 active	MARKETPLACE A\$41K 2 active
CHANNEL A\$20K 1 active	OEM A\$15K 1 active

YEAR 1 · RECONCILIATION

Var = BU – TD

METRIC	TD · R2	BU · R3	VAR	STATUS
Leads	3,500	218	-3,282	BELOW
Trials	875	65	-810	BELOW
Activations	263	35	-228	BELOW
Revenue	A\$6.0M	A\$465K	-A\$5.5M	BELOW

YEAR 2 · RECONCILIATION

Var = BU – TD

METRIC	TD · R2	BU · R3	VAR	STATUS
Leads	5,500	405	-5,095	BELOW
Trials	1,540	122	-1,418	BELOW
Activations	493	62	-431	BELOW
Revenue	A\$8.4M	A\$866K	-A\$7.5M	BELOW

Sense check. The bottom-up build is materially below the R2 Partner-Led top-down ambition on every funnel tier across both years. Close the gap by adding more partners targeted in the R3 cat × region table, lifting activation %, or revising the R2 Revenue % share down to a defensible level.

SECTION 05

How to Win.

What we want from partners · across the journey.

Partner expectations at each customer-journey stage. Each item has a maturity marker: C = Crawl baseline must-have · W = Walk repeatable motion · R = Run scaled and strategic.

	Awareness	Consideration	Activation	Expansion	Retention
Partner activities	- C · Participates in at least 2 joint events / yr - C · Uses approved SafetyCulture brand kit + messaging - W · Runs a repeatable awareness motion (LinkedIn, podcast, content) - W · Reports activity volume quarterly - R · Operates a governed second-degree partner program	- C · Submits a clear hand-off to a SafetyCulture seller - W · Tracks buyer stage in shared CRM / PRM - R · Operates a governed partner sourcing motion - R · Provides category authority signals (analyst coverage)	- C · Supports handover from sales to onboarding - W · Runs a repeatable activation motion - W · Reports activation activity quarterly - R · Operates a governed delivery network - R · Contributes adoption playbooks for SafetyCulture	- C · Identifies and flags expansion signals - C · Participates in at least 1 joint expansion play / yr - W · Runs a repeatable expansion motion - W · Reports expansion activity quarterly - R · Operates a governed expansion network	- C · Monitors and reports churn-risk signals - C · Participates in at least 1 customer success review / yr - W · Runs a repeatable success motion - W · Reports customer health quarterly - R · Operates a governed customer-success network
Partner value add	- C · Contributes trusted brand authority - W · Packages audience and reach reporting - R · Creates a scalable awareness asset library	- C · Contributes buyer context to the pitch - W · Packages buyer conviction collateral (battlecards, case studies) - R · Creates scalable buyer-content assets	- C · Contributes implementation capacity - W · Packages implementation playbooks - R · Creates scalable implementation assets	- C · Contributes use-case expansion - W · Packages use-case adoption - R · Creates scalable expansion assets	- C · Contributes customer health signals - W · Packages customer success programmes - R · Creates scalable retention assets
Business outcomes	- C · Produces a visible top-of-funnel lift - W · Improves repeatable lead volume - R · Sustains measurable brand awareness gain	- C · Produces a visible influenced pipeline - W · Improves repeatable conversion to opportunity - R · Sustains measurable sourced-pipeline contribution	- C · Produces a visible activation rate lift - W · Improves repeatable activation velocity - R · Sustains measurable onboarded volume	- C · Produces a visible expansion ARR uplift - W · Improves repeatable NRR contribution - R · Sustains measurable expansion ARR	- C · Produces a visible retention rate uplift - W · Improves repeatable customer-health scores - R · Sustains measurable GRR uplift

What SafetyCulture offers partners · across the journey.

Across the journey. With a Crawl / Walk / Run build. What SafetyCulture brings to each partner at each stage, expressed as activities, value-add and business outcomes. The mirror image of the previous page.

	Awareness	Consideration	Activation	Expansion	Retention
Our Activities	C · Co-branded thought leadership C · Joint webinar + podcast slots W · Always-on social co-amplification R · Partner-led HSA event programme	C · Joint battlecards + case studies W · Joint demo environments R · Co-sell + deal-reg motion	C · Onboarding training + certifications W · Joint implementation playbooks R · Co-delivered enterprise rollouts	C · Shared expansion playbooks W · Joint customer business reviews R · Co-funded expansion campaigns	C · Customer success enablement W · Health-score dashboards R · Joint retention QBRs
Our Value Add	SafetyCulture audience reach · brand authority · MDF.	Buyer access · lead routing · co-sell IP.	Activation toolkit · certified consultants · tooling.	Expansion plays · joint roadmap · integrations.	Customer health data · renewal toolkits.
Our Business Outcomes	Partner-sourced top of funnel · lower CAC.	Partner-sourced pipeline · faster sales velocity.	Higher activation rate · faster time-to-value.	Higher NRR · expanded ACV.	Higher GRR · reduced churn.

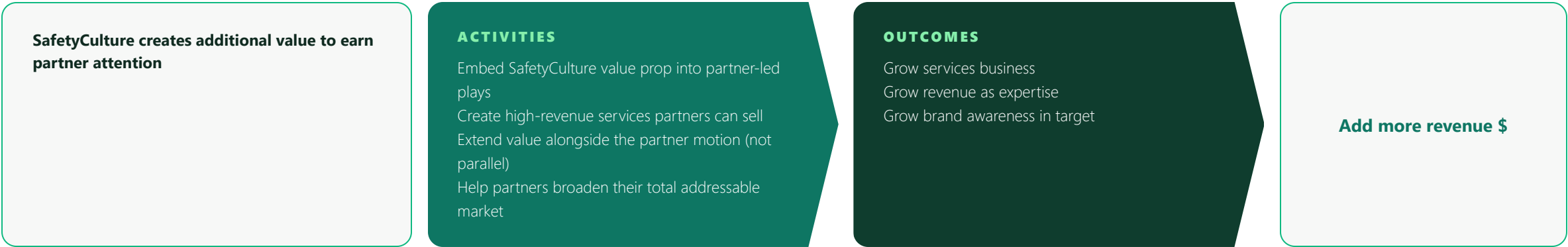
SafetyCulture creates additional value to earn partner attention.

Partners already make money the way they make money today. Anything we offer has to be additive to that motion, not parallel to it. Every input we drive must connect to partner revenue.

TOP OF FUNNEL · TODAY'S MOTION



BOTTOM OF FUNNEL · ADDITIVE MOTION



The implication: every value statement SafetyCulture makes to partners must connect to *their* revenue, not ours. Partners pick partners who help them sell more services.

SECTION 06

Crawl, Walk, Run Strategy.

Four key workstreams to make this partnership program a success.

The highest-leverage workstreams across the first 90 days. Each compounds into the 18-month 25% partner-sourced target.

WS-01

★

EFFORT · HIGH

ROI · HIGH

Stand up the partnerships function

Name a Head of Partnerships reporting into Revenue. Stand up the RevOps embed for partner attribution. Set fortnightly executive partnership review cadence.

OWNER

Alex Chen · CRO

WINDOW

Day 0 → Day 28

WS-02

★

EFFORT · HIGH

ROI · HIGH

Activate top 12 priority partners

Per-partner activation kit across Q1/Q2: champion, contract paper, joint motion, T+30/T+90 success criteria. Scope: Microsoft, AWS, Salesforce, Workday, ServiceNow, Accenture, Deloitte, PwC + 4 more.

OWNER

Priya Singh · Head of Partnerships

WINDOW

Day 28 → Day 75

WS-03

★

EFFORT · MED

ROI · HIGH

Lock executive alignment + targets

Run the workshop with the executive sponsor and lock the 12 / 24-month partner-sourced targets (25% / 34%). Fortnightly partnership review cadence with the CRO.

OWNER

Alex Chen · CRO

WINDOW

Day 0 → Day 14

WS-08

★

EFFORT · MED

ROI · HIGH

Bottom-up model + Crawl/Walk/Run cadence

Build the Bottom-Up Partnership Model (8 categories × 4 regions). Run the Crawl / Walk / Run review with the executive sponsor every 90 days. Reconciles top-down vs bottom-up.

OWNER

Priya Singh + Alex Chen

WINDOW

Day 20 → ongoing

Crawl · Walk · Run Strategy.

Phasing the path forward. The partnership plan bucketed by due date into Crawl (Days 1-90), Walk (Days 90-180) and Run (Days 180+). Crawl lays the foundation, Walk builds the partner motion, Run scales the programme.

CRAWL

Days 1-90

- Run the workshop and lock 12 / 24-month targets
- Reconcile partner-sourced ARR target (<5% variance)
- Stand up the partnerships function with a named owner
- Land the top 3 priority categories as Year-1 commitments
- Run partner-program qualification on the top 12 (4-C + customer gate)
- Migrate to canonical 4-C ICP scoring across all recommended partners
- Ship the executive scorecard + cadence (weekly · monthly · QBR)
- Build the partner-facing value proposition
- Define partner expectations · behavioural · commercial · cultural
- Close the integration-readiness blockers
- Build the Bottom-Up Partnership Model (8 cats × 4 regions)
- Wire inputs → outputs and prove the measurement loop
- Activate top 12 priority partners across Q1/Q2 with named owners
- Run the Crawl / Walk / Run review every 90 days

WALK

Days 90-180

- Map second-degree partners and name intersections to drive co-activation
- Build the Non-Financial Partner Marketing programme (10 motions, ranked)
- Lock partner expectations across the 5 customer-journey stages
- Stand up CRM/PRM with partner-attribution fields + workflows
- Launch the partner programme publicly (collateral + comms + portal)
- Hit 12% partner-sourced of new ARR by T+180

RUN

Days 180+

- *Scale the programme. Move from 12% partner-sourced (T+180) toward the 25% 18-month target and the 34% Year-2 aspiration anchored on hyperscaler co-sell, Tier-1 GSI delivery and embedded ISVs.*

Key areas of focus · 24-month timeline.

Starred workstreams plotted across the next 24 months by due date. High-priority milestones in red, medium in amber, sustained outcomes in emerald.

KEY AREAS OF FOCUS · TIMELINE · 24 MONTHS

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4 · FY26	Q1 FY27	Q2 FY27	H2 FY27	FY28
WS-01 ★ Function	JD signed							
WS-02 ★ Top 12 partners		Top 12 named · Q2 wave						
WS-03 ★ Exec alignment	Sponsor wkshp			QBR · target lock				
WS-04 CRM/PRM + attrib		ARR reconcile		CRM/PRM live · attribution				
WS-06 Mktg + journey				10 motions ranked · 5 piloted				
WS-07 Public launch					Programme launch			
Global playbook							Playbook v1 · ANZ → EMEA → AMER	
WS-08 ★ Bottom-up + CWR		Model live						30%+ sourced

High priority Medium priority Low priority

★ = STARRED · KEY AREAS OF FOCUS

HockeyStick

**Powering your
Partner Led Revenue.**